Stage 1 Background – Market Research Report

2026-09-22 · @Someone

Purpose and scope

This report gathers the real-world data behind Stage 1 (Background) for our startup: a web-based B2B SaaS that scrapes Chilean car listings, estimates each car's fair price with a regression model, and uses an LLM to classify each listing as a good or bad deal. Target clients are scrapyards (desarmadurías), used-car dealers (compraventas / automotoras) and franchised dealerships (concesionarias), billed by monthly subscription and hosted on a cloud provider.

It covers only the "Investigate" column of our Stage 1 create-vs-investigate map; company details (name, history, mission, team) are created later in the deck. Every source cited was opened and checked on the date above; unverifiable figures are flagged.

1. Business Category

We sit in B2B automotive price intelligence: a data-analytics SaaS that turns public listings into pricing decisions for car businesses. In Chile, no verified player sells scraped cross-portal pricing plus deal classification to dealers and scrapyards; incumbents sell vehicle-history reports and listing space.

Data sources (portals we would scrape)

Portal	What it is	Size seen (22 Sep 2026)	Crawling policy (robots.txt)
Chileautos	Largest classifieds site; owned by Australia's carsales.com since 2016 (83% for USD 15M), 100% since Dec 2018 (LexLatin)	70,039 vehicles listed	Disallows `/vehiculos` and `/resultados` for general bots (robots.txt)
Yapo.cl	General classifieds; calls itself Chile's #1 used-car platform	34,032 used-car listings	Listings allowed; blocks only ajax/captcha paths (robots.txt)
Mercado Libre Autos	Marketplace with vehicle category	Not verifiable	Automated access to autos.mercadolibre.cl is disallowed by robots.txt

Portal	What it is	Size seen (22 Sep 2026)	Crawling policy (robots.txt)
Kavak	Buys, reconditions and resells used cars; in Chile since 2022, 500+ cars on display, 160 staff at its Macul hub (Chócale, Sep 2024)	Page blocks automated access	Not checked

Competitors and substitutes

Player	Offer	Overlap with us
Autofact	Commercial value lookup by plate or model; paid history report	Price reference for single cars, no deal scoring or alerts
Autofact Pro	B2B: history reports, digital transfers, fines, trade-in tools; clients include Derco, Rosselot, Kovacs	Same buyers (dealers); no market-wide price intelligence
CarGurus (US, reference only)	Instant Market Value from comparable listings; deal ratings Great / Good / Fair / High / Overpriced	Closest model to ours; not present in Chile
Manual research	Staff browsing portals and spreadsheets	The status quo we replace

Implication: our niche is B2B, cross-portal and decision-oriented ("is this a good buy?"), which the Chilean incumbents do not cover.

2. History context

Our origin story fits a market that moved online over the last decade: foreign capital entered Chilean car classifieds, digital-first dealers arrived, and nearly every household is now connected. These dated facts can anchor the created founder story.

Date	Event	Source
2025	E-commerce reaches about US$10 billion, +9% real growth, 12.6% of retail	CCS, Mar 2026

Date	Event	Source
2024	96.5% of households have internet access (fixed or mobile)	Subtel survey via CPI, Feb 2025
Sep 2024	Kavak opens an 18,000 m² hub in Macul after two years in Chile	Chócale
Dec 2018	carsales.com takes 100% of Chileautos	LexLatin
Mar 2016	carsales.com buys 83% of Chileautos for USD 15M	LexLatin

No verified figure exists for SaaS adoption among Chilean car dealers; paid market-research reports on the Chilean SaaS market were found but not accessible, so they are not cited.

3. Vision and Mission: competitor references

All three reference players frame their purpose around trust and information asymmetry in used cars, framed for consumers. Our statement can be distinguished by speaking to businesses and to decisions (buy, price, sell) rather than to transparency alone.

Company	Statement (verbatim)	Audience
Autofact (Chile, founded 2012)	Purpose: "eliminar la asimetría de información en el mercado de vehículos usados". Mission: "Democratizar el acceso a la información vehicular y digitalizar trámites notariales complejos…"	Consumers and dealers
Kavak	"We want to empower people by helping them solve everything related to one of their most important assets: their car."	Consumers
CarGurus (US, founded 2006)	"bring more trust and transparency to car shopping"	Consumers

4. Business Model: benchmarks and feasibility

Chilean dealer software already sells at about 1.5–9 UF per month, and running the LLM classification costs well under US$100 per month at portal scale. The biggest constraint is legal: the largest portal, Chileautos, bans automated extraction in its terms of use.

Pricing benchmarks (UF = CLP 40,991.75 on 22 Sep 2026, mindicador.cl)

Product	What it sells	Price	Source
Vendicar	Dealer management: inventory, CRM, web publishing	1.5 / 3 / 6 / 9 UF + VAT per month (about CLP 61k–369k), tiers by users and cars	vendicar.cl
AutoGest Pro	Dealer management incl. an "AI valuation tool" and portal analytics	CLP 59,990 per month (about 1.5 UF); CLP 49,998 per month on 6-month billing	autogest.cl
Chileautos listings	Price per car advert	CLP 5,900–9,400 standard; up to CLP 65,900 Premium Pro	Chileautos help centre

AutoGest's built-in valuation feature is a direct partial competitor for small automotoras and should be added to the competitor list.

Product pipeline (web-based, no app needed)

```
flowchart LR
  A[Listing portals<br/>+ partner feeds] --> B[Scrapers]
  B --> C[Cleaning &<br/>deduplication]
  C --> D[Regression model<br/>fair-price estimate]
  D --> E[LLM classifier<br/>good / fair / bad deal]
  E --> F[Web dashboard<br/>+ alerts]
```

The regression predicts a fair price from brand, model, year, mileage, fuel, transmission and region. The LLM then reads the listing text, the asking price and the predicted price, and returns a label plus a one-line reason. CarGurus uses the same logic (asking price vs. estimated market value) with five labels (CarGurus help).

LLM cost per month (assumption: 100,000 listings classified, 800 input + 150 output tokens each, batch pricing)

Model	Batch price, input / output per 1M tokens	Monthly cost	Source
OpenAI GPT-5.6 Luna	US$0.10 / US$0.60 (50% off list US$0.20 / US$1.20)	about US$17	OpenAI pricing
Google Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	about US$0.13 / US$0.75 (50% off list US$0.25 / US$1.50)	about US$21	Gemini pricing
Anthropic Claude Haiku 4.5	US$0.50 / US$2.50	about US$78	Claude pricing

Legal and technical feasibility of scraping

- Chileautos terms of use prohibit "la utilización de cualquier proceso automatizado de cualquier tipo para consultar, acceder, recuperar, extraer datos", and its robots.txt blocks `/vehiculos` for general bots.
- Yapo robots.txt allows listing pages; its terms of use were not reviewed.
- Mercado Libre blocks automated access to its autos site via robots.txt; a data partnership or official API would be needed.
- Ley 21.719 on personal data (published 13 Dec 2024) takes effect 1 Dec 2026, creates a Data Protection Agency and sets fines up to 20,000 UTM. SMEs get warnings instead of fines until Dec 2027. Seller names and phone numbers are personal data; car specs and prices are not.

Implication for the business model: collect only vehicle data (no seller contacts), start with portals that allow crawling, and pursue data-licensing agreements with Chileautos and Mercado Libre. Client dealers can also connect their own stock feeds.

5. Structure and Infrastructure: reference costs

Infrastructure is cheap and people are the main cost: an MVP stack fits in roughly US$100–200 per month, while one semi-senior data engineer costs CLP 2.8–4.0M gross per month.

Cloud (supplier) reference prices

Item	Price	Source
Virtual server, 2 GB RAM / 1 vCPU	US$12 per month	DigitalOcean
Virtual server, 4 GB RAM / 2 vCPU	US$24 per month	DigitalOcean
Virtual server, 8 GB RAM / 4 vCPU	US$48 per month	DigitalOcean

Item	Price	Source
LLM classification, 100k listings	US$17–78 per month	Section 4

AWS announced on 7 May 2025 a US$4 billion investment for a Chile region with three availability zones, planned by end-2026 (Amazon press release); it already has Local Zones in Santiago since 2023 (AWS blog). Local hosting lowers latency and eases data-residency concerns under Ley 21.719.

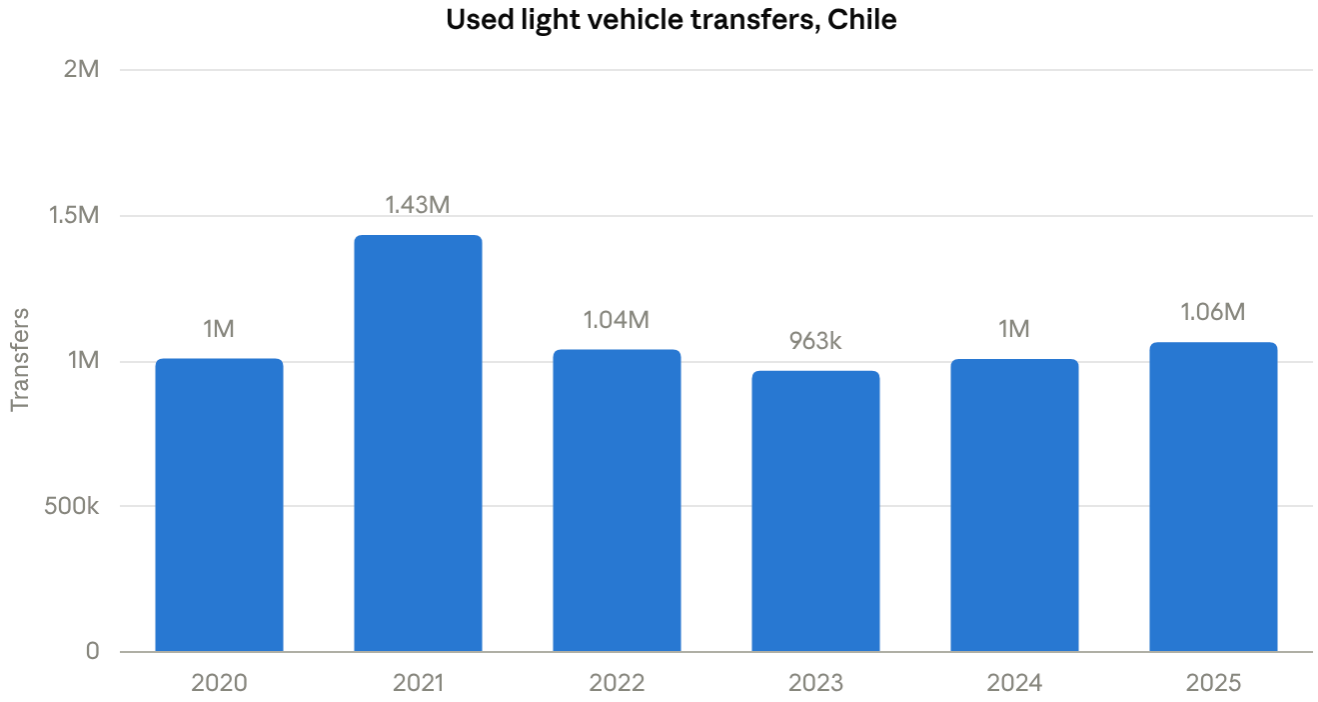
Salaries, Santiago, gross CLP per month (P25–P75, IT Workers 2026 guide)

Role	Junior	Semi-senior	Senior
Backend / full-stack developer	0.8–1.2M	1.8–2.8M	2.8–4.2M
Data engineer	1.2–1.8M	2.8–4.0M	4.0–6.0M
Data scientist / ML engineer	1.2–1.8M	2.8–4.2M	4.2–6.5M

No verified salary source was found for marketing or B2B sales roles; the guide covers technical roles only.

6. Current Situation: the market

Chile's used-car market is large and stable: 1,060,919 used transfers in 2025 (+5.8%), about 3.4 used cars per new car, and 2026 is on track to pass one million again.



CAVEM figures as reported by REDIMIN, Sep 2026

CAVEM via REDIMIN · 2020–2025

Key figures

Indicator	Value	Source
Used transfers, Jan–Aug 2026	736,120 (+4.1% y/y); second-best Jan–Aug on record	REDIMIN, citing CAVEM
Used transfers bought by companies, Aug 2026	14,231 of 87,748 (16.2%)	PressLatam, citing CAVEM
New vehicle sales 2025	310,598 (+2.7%)	Diario Estrategia, citing ANAC
Used per new ratio	3.4 in 2025; 3.5 Jan–Aug 2026	Autofact, REDIMIN
Vehicles in circulation 2024	6,727,472 permits (+2.9%); 36.8% in the Metropolitan Region	Cooperativa, citing INE
Average asking price, Chileautos	CLP 18,396,548 in 2025 vs 17,527,519 in 2024 (+5%)	Emol
Searches on Chileautos 2025	142 million	24horas
Online listings (snapshot 22 Sep 2026)	70,039 on Chileautos; 34,032 used on Yapo	Section 1

Price dispersion is the core argument for our product. The same model, a Ford F-150, was listed on Chileautos in 2025 between CLP 2,000,000 and CLP 68,900,000, averaging CLP 30,844,283 (Emol). Segments also move differently: hatchbacks +5%, pickups +4%, sedans +3%, SUVs slightly down in 2025. A buyer cannot judge a price without model-level comparables.

No verified data exists on SaaS adoption among Chilean dealers; the existence of paid dealer tools (Vendicar, AutoGest, Autofact Pro) shows willingness to pay for software.

7. Scope: where and how big

Santiago first is justified by the data: the Metropolitan Region accounts for 58.0% of all used transfers (615,311 of 1,060,919 in 2025). Businesses buy about one in six used cars, which sizes the professional demand we serve.

Scope indicators

Indicator	Value	Source
Used transfers in the Metropolitan Region, 2025	615,311 (58.0%); next: Valparaíso 70,983, Biobío 62,191	CAVEM Anuario 2025
Share of used cars bought by companies	16.2% (Aug 2026)	PressLatam, citing CAVEM
Transferred cars aged 16+ years, 2025 (scrapyard supply)	252,405 (23.8%)	CAVEM Anuario 2025
Transferred cars aged 0–5 years, 2025 (dealership trade-ins)	273,033 (25.7%)	CAVEM Anuario 2025
Households with internet, 2024	96.5%	Subtel via CPI

Market size, transaction view (our estimate from the sources above)

- TAM: 1,060,919 used transfers per year in Chile, each one a pricing decision.
- SAM: about 172,000 per year bought by companies (16.2% of 2025 transfers, applying the Aug 2026 share), the purchases our B2B clients make.
- SOM (Santiago, year 1): 58% of SAM is about 100,000 business purchases; the target share of clients is defined in Stage 4.

Number of target businesses: open item. No verified count of desarmadurías, compraventas or concesionarias was found. CAVEM claims to represent over 90% of automotive entrepreneurs but publishes no member count (CAVEM). Desarmadurías

have no national registry; a registry was proposed in Congress in Feb 2025 (G5noticias). The official count is in SII company statistics by economic activity, 2005–2024 (SII), whose file could not be downloaded from this environment.

8. Main Actions: competitor references

The incumbents market mainly through data-driven press studies, content and free trials, a playbook that suits a data startup that can publish its own price findings.

Company	Observed action	Source
Chileautos	Press studies built on its own listing data (e.g. "20 most-listed used cars that dropped in price", Sep 2024; 2025 price and search review, Feb 2026), fronted by its CEO	El Mostrador, Emol
Chileautos	Campus Chileautos: training for dealers	Help centre
Autofact	Content marketing: consumer blog (market balances, dealer directories, scrapyard guides)	Autofact blog
Autofact Pro	B2B site with named dealer clients (Derco, Rosselot, Kovacs) and testimonials	autofactpro.com
AutoGest	10-day free trial, discounts for quarterly and semi-annual billing	autogest.cl
Vendicar	No minimum contract, 2-day setup, 24/7 WhatsApp support	vendicar.cl
Kavak	Physical experience centre in Macul, launched with press coverage	Chócale

Implications for the startup definition

1. **Position as B2B price intelligence**, not another consumer valuation tool; Autofact and CarGurus own the consumer transparency message.
2. **Price the subscription near existing dealer software** (about 1.5–9 UF per month); LLM and cloud costs leave ample margin.
3. **Launch in Santiago** (58% of used transfers), then Valparaíso and Biobío.
4. **Data strategy must be compliant**: vehicle data only, crawl-permitted portals first, licensing talks with Chileautos and Mercado Libre, and client stock feeds.

5. **Name AutoGest's AI valuation** as the closest local competitor feature and differentiate on cross-portal coverage and deal classification.
6. **Close the open item**: count of desarmadurías, compraventas and concesionarias from SII statistics.

Source verification log

Every source cited above was opened on 22 Sep 2026 and the quoted figure was found on the page. Sources that failed or were excluded:

Source	Result	Treatment
SII company statistics file (PUB_ACT.xlsb)	Page opens; binary file blocked by this environment's network	Open item (Section 7)
Mercado Libre Autos	robots.txt disallows automated access	Listing count not reported
Kavak listings page	HTTP 403	Used press article instead
Chileautos used-car results page	HTTP 403	Used homepage total instead
CarGurus deal-ratings page	HTTP 404	Used CarGurus help centre instead
Autofact "used-car websites" article	HTTP 403	Not cited
PasionMotor used-car article (Jun 2026)	Figures (991,431 transfers; 254,000 new) contradict CAVEM	Excluded
Robert Half 2026 salary guide	No figures on the page	Not cited
Chile SaaS market reports (IMARC, Verified, Data Cube)	Paywalled	Not cited
Google Cloud region list	Santiago region not confirmed on the fetched page	Not cited